

The Stamp Card Loyalty Engine

One free reward. A lifetime of repeat customers.

What It Is

A done-for-you loyalty program built around a physical stamp card. You set up any local business — a coffee shop, barber, juice bar, nail salon, taco stand — with branded "buy 9, get the 10th free" punch cards plus the signage and staff scripts to push them. You can run this for your own shop or sell it as a service to other local businesses that have no retention system at all.

How It Makes Money

Two paths. **Path A (your own shop):** the card lifts repeat visits and average customer lifetime value, so the same foot traffic spends more. **Path B (agency model):** you charge local businesses a setup fee plus a small monthly retainer to design, print, and manage their loyalty program. The buyers are owner-operated shops that live and die on regulars but have never built a reason for customers to come back.

Startup Costs

- Card design (Canva or a Fiverr designer): \$0–\$120
- Custom-printed cards, 1,000 units (16pt cardstock, full color): \$60–\$150
- Custom stamp or hole-punch tool: \$15–\$45
- Counter sign / table tent display: \$20–\$60
- Optional QR-based digital version (Loopy Loyalty / Stamp Me app): \$30–\$50/mo
- Total to launch: **\$130–\$400**

The Numbers

Printed cards run about **\$0.06–\$0.12 each** at 1,000 units. If you sell the program to other shops, a typical package is a **\$300 setup fee + \$99/month** to keep cards stocked and the offer refreshed. Land 10 local clients and that's **\$3,000 setup + ~\$990/month recurring**. For your own shop, the math is even stronger: if a stamp card converts a one-time buyer into someone who visits 9 extra times before the free reward, a \$5 coffee customer becomes a \$45 customer — and the free 10th drink costs you maybe \$0.80 in beans.

How To Start

1. Pick your lane: run it in your own business or sell it to 3–5 local shops first.
2. Design a clean card — logo, 10 stamp slots, the reward, and an expiry to drive urgency.
3. Order 1,000 cards from a local printer or Vistaprint; buy a custom ink stamp.
4. Write a 1-line staff script: "Want a free [X]? Here's your card — first stamp's on me."
5. Pre-stamp the first 1–2 slots. The "endowed progress effect" makes a half-started card feel almost done, so people chase completion.
6. Place a counter sign so every customer sees the offer at the point of sale.
7. Track redemption rates for 30 days; tune the reward so it's exciting but cheap to give.

Where To Get Customers

For the agency model: walk into independent coffee shops, salons, smoothie bars, and barbers within 5 miles and pitch in person — owners respond to foot traffic. Post before/after "repeat customer" case studies on local Facebook groups and Instagram. Cold-DM shops with under 5,000 followers that clearly have regulars but no loyalty offer. For your own shop, just hand a card to every single customer at checkout — no exceptions.

Pro Tips

- **Pre-stamp the card.** Starting customers at 2/10 instead of 0/10 dramatically increases completion — people hate leaving a near-finished thing unfinished.
- **Make the reward feel premium but cost you little.** A "free specialty drink" sounds richer than "free coffee" but costs nearly the same.
- **Add an expiry date.** A card that never expires creates zero urgency; "complete within 60 days" doubles visit frequency.